

Roni Shefer

Data Scientist

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Professional Summary

Data scientist with 4 years turning business questions into models that ship. Day-to-day work is Python and SQL: feature building on warehouse data, gradient-boosted models for churn and demand, and the experiment design that decides whether a model earns its place in the product.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, R (reading level)

Analysis: pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, statsmodels

Data: BigQuery, PostgreSQL, dbt

Visualisation: matplotlib, Looker

Deep learning: PyTorch

Practices: A/B testing, experiment design, cross-validation, code review

Professional Experience

Data Scientist *Vantage Retail Group, Haifa*

- Built the churn model behind the retention programme (XGBoost on 180 features); Mar 2023 - Present lifted campaign precision from 0.31 to 0.58 and it now drives a monthly 12K-customer contact list.
- Own demand forecasting for 2,400 SKUs in Python; MAPE improved from 24% to 15% after rebuilding the feature set around promotion calendars.
- Designed and read out 30+ A/B tests with the product team, including three that stopped planned launches on statistically flat results.
- Wrote the SQL and dbt models feeding the analytics layer used by four business teams.

Data Analyst *Meridian Insights, Tel Aviv*

- Delivered weekly reporting and ad-hoc analysis in SQL and Python for a 40-person commercial org. Jul 2021 - Mar 2023
- Automated a manual Excel reporting cycle into a scheduled pandas pipeline, saving ~6 hours/week.
- Trained a first PyTorch classifier for support-ticket routing as a side project; it reached 78% accuracy offline but was never deployed.
- Ran the onboarding sessions that taught six analysts to query the warehouse directly.

Projects

Price elasticity study - Python and statsmodels analysis across 14 product categories; the results changed the discount policy for two of them.

Forecast backtesting harness - reusable pandas framework for rolling-origin evaluation, now the team's default way to compare demand models.

Education

M.Sc. Statistics, University of Haifa - thesis on hierarchical time-series forecasting 2019 - 2021

B.Sc. Industrial Engineering and Management, Technion 2015 - 2019

Languages

Hebrew - native, English - fluent, Russian - conversational.